

Getting this live on everyone's phones

Two parts: (1) turn on real cross-device sync (~3 min, optional but recommended), (2) put the app on the internet so you can add it to your home screens (~2 min). No coding in either step — just copy/paste and clicking.

Part 1 — Turn on sync (Firebase, free)

Without this step the app still works great, it just won't share data between phones — each person would see their own local copy.

1. Go to <https://console.firebase.google.com> and sign in with any Google account.
2. Click **Add project** → give it any name (e.g. "nyc-trip") → you can skip Google Analytics → **Create project**.
3. In the left sidebar click **Build** → **Firestore Database** → **Create database** → choose **Start in test mode** → pick any location → **Enable**. (Test mode means anyone with the link can read/write — fine for a private trip app only your group will use. Firestore's free tier is generous; this app is far too small to ever hit a paywall.)
4. Click the gear icon (⚙️) next to "Project Overview" → **Project settings**. Scroll to **Your apps** → click the `</>` (web) icon → nickname it anything → **Register app**. Firebase will show you a code block containing a `firebaseConfig = { ... } object`.
5. Open **firebase-config.js** in this folder and paste those six values in, replacing the placeholders. Leave everything else in that file alone.
6. Optional: change `window.TRIP_CODE` in that same file to something memorable (e.g. `"nyc-oct-belle"`) — this is just the shared key that links your group's devices together.

That's it — the app now syncs live for anyone using it.

Part 2 — Put it online (Netlify, free, drag-and-drop)

1. Go to <https://app.netlify.com/drop>
2. Drag the whole **app** folder (this folder, containing index.html, style.css, app.js, etc.) into the browser window.
3. Netlify gives you a live URL in about 10 seconds, e.g. `https://random-name-`

`123.netlify.app` . That's your app — send that link to the group chat.

4. (Optional, for a nicer URL) Click **Site settings** → **Change site name** to pick something like `nyc-girls-trip.netlify.app` .

Everyone adds it to their home screen

- **iPhone:** open the link in Safari → tap the Share icon → **Add to Home Screen**.
- **Android:** open the link in Chrome → tap the : menu → **Add to Home screen / Install app**.

It'll open full-screen with its own icon, like a normal app.

Pushing updates later

Whenever you want to change something in the code itself (not the trip data — that already updates live for everyone), just edit the files and drag the folder into <https://app.netlify.com/drop> again, or connect the same folder to a GitHub repo from the Netlify dashboard (**Site settings** → **Build & deploy** → **Link repository**) if you want it to auto-update whenever you push to GitHub. Ask Claude for the git commands if you want to set that up.

If you skip Part 1

The app defaults to on-device storage — every feature still works, but changes won't appear on your friends' phones. The little pill at the top of the app tells you which mode you're in ("Synced live" vs "This device only").